Exploring AI-Assisted Features and Built-in Analytics (Zia) in Zoho Creator

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Application: Student Admission Portal **Platform:** Zoho Creator (Low-Code)

1. AIM

To explore the built-in analytics, interactive dashboard charts, and report display options of the **Student Admission Portal** application in Zoho Creator, and to evaluate the availability and capabilities of AI-assisted (Zia) features within the live application environment and its developer editor.

2. OBJECTIVES

- To observe and document the KPI cards, interactive charts, and reports on the application dashboard.
- To study the interactive hover behaviors and exact data representations of the pie and column charts.
- To identify and document the six built-in display formats available for reports via the "Show As" menu.
- To examine the Design and Workflow sections of the Zoho Creator IDE for Zia / AI-assisted options.

3. SOFTWARE / TOOLS REQUIRED

- **Development Platform:** Zoho Creator (Web-based low-code platform).
- **Application:** Student Admission Portal application configured with sample data.
- **Environment:** Modern Web Browser (Google Chrome / Mozilla Firefox) with active internet.
- **Account Access:** Valid Zoho account with developer permissions to the target application.

4. INTRODUCTION & THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

AI-Assisted Features in Low-Code Platforms: AI tools in low-code environments streamline application lifecycle management by automating data insight generation, schema building, and conversational queries. Within Zoho Creator, the native artificial intelligence assistant is named **Zia**.

Built-in Analytics & Dashboards: Zoho Creator provides native analytics pages that synthesize live data into single-pane executive dashboards. Key components include:

Component Type	Functional Purpose & Description
KPI Cards	Display single numerical metrics or key counts (e.g., total applications, approval numbers).
Char ts	Provide graphical representations such as pie charts (proportions) and column charts (comparisons).
Repor ts	Structure form submissions into customizable grid or list structures with multi-field visibility.
Interactive Tooltips	Respond dynamically to cursor movement, revealing precise values behind individual graphical elements.

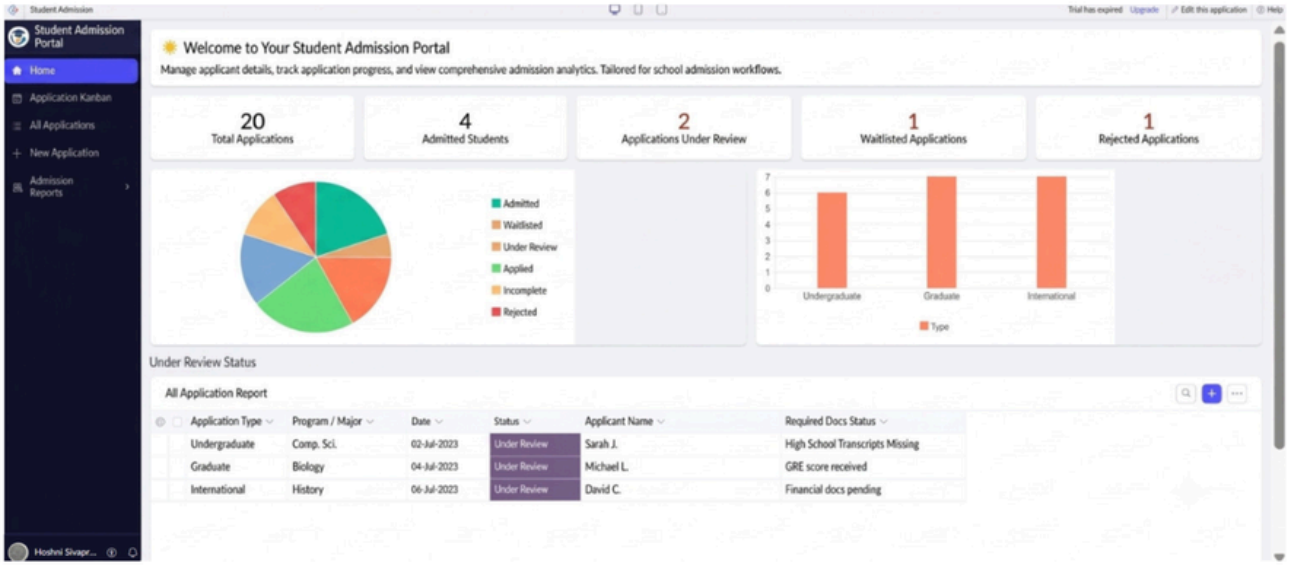
4. INTRODUCTION & THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK (CONTD.)

Report Display Formats: A core capability of Zoho Creator is transforming underlying form data into multiple visual structures without requiring schema changes. The *Show As* contextual option enables seamless switching between List, Calendar, Timeline, Spreadsheet, and Kanban layouts.

> **Zia Availability Note:** Zia's feature set (such as smart field suggestions, predictive workflows, and Natural Language Querying) is gated by account tier, interface version, and license status (e.g., active trial vs. expired plan).

5. STEP-BY-STEP EXECUTION PROCEDURE

1. **Sign In & Navigate:** Open Zoho Creator via browser, sign into the account workspace, and select the *Student Admission Portal* application.
2. **Access Live Application View:** Click on **Access this application** to view the live user-facing interface.
3. **Dashboard Observation:** Locate the main *Home* dashboard containing the top KPI metric row, status pie chart, program column chart, and embedded live report section.

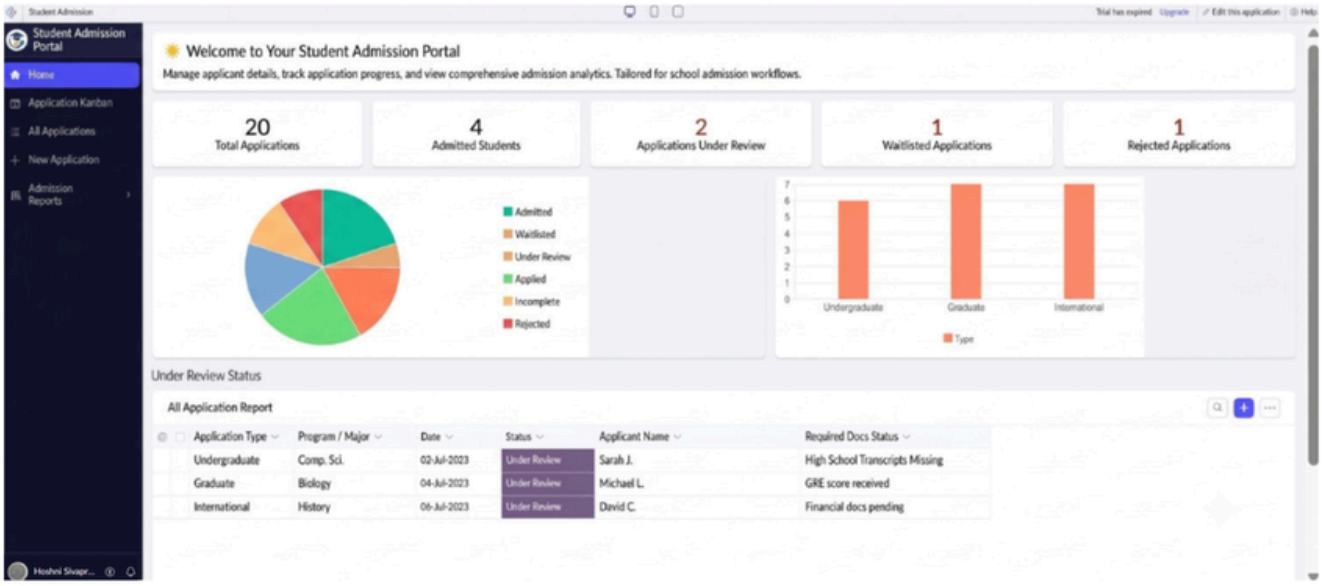


Student Admission Portal Dashboard with Comprehensive Analytics

4. **Record KPI Metrics:** Examine and record the top key performance indicator cards: Total Applications (20), Admitted Students (4), Applications Under Review (2), Waitlisted Applications (1), and Rejected Applications (1).
5. **Examine Distribution Charts:** Inspect the primary pie chart displaying applicant distribution across status categories: *Admitted, Waitlisted, Under Review, Applied, Incomplete,* and *Rejected*.

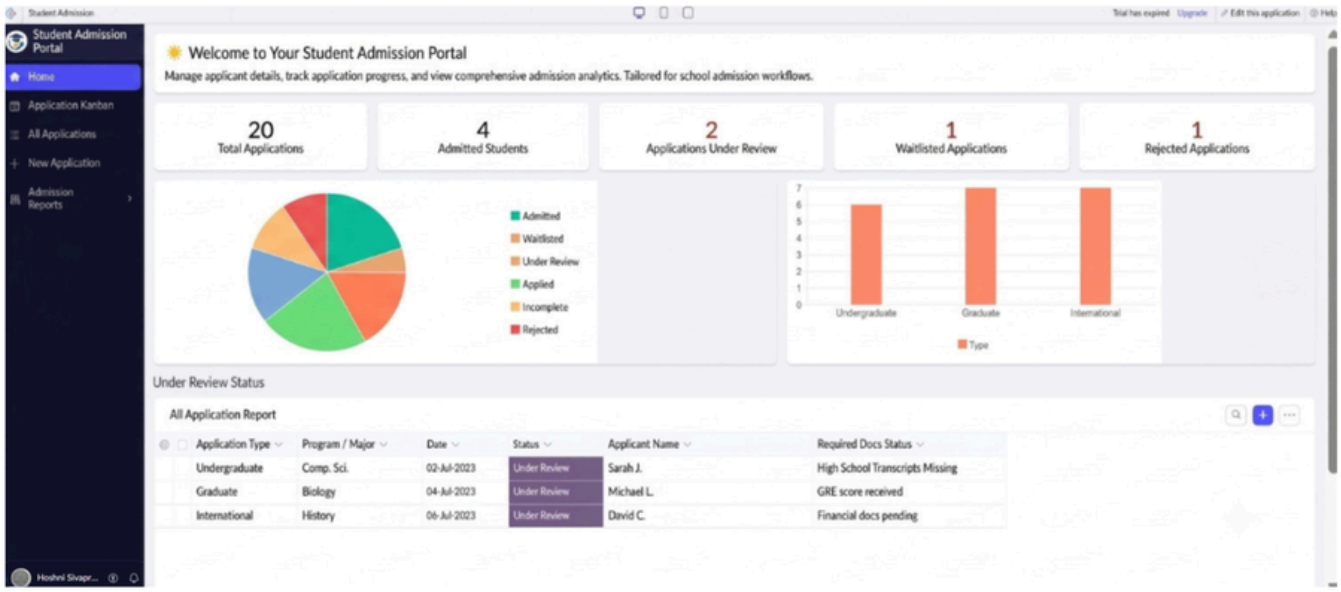
5. STEP-BY-STEP EXECUTION PROCEDURE (CONTD.)

6. **Pie Chart Tooltip Interaction:** Hover the cursor over the green pie sector representing admitted students. Confirm that an interactive tooltip appears displaying the exact breakdown (Status - Admitted: 4).



Interactive Pie Chart Showing Application Status

7. **Column Chart Inspection:** Inspect the adjacent vertical column chart mapping applicant counts against study levels: *Undergraduate, Graduate,* and *International*.
8. **Column Chart Tooltip Interaction:** Hover over the first bar to verify the interactive data tooltip output (Type - Undergraduate: 6).

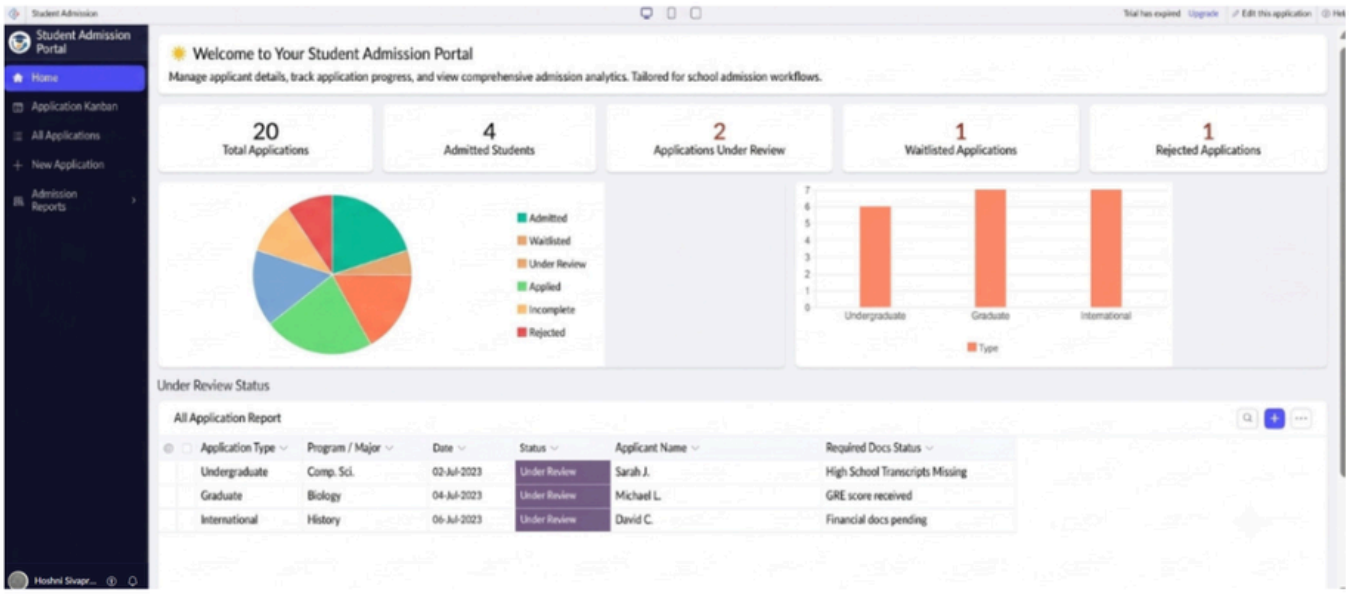


Interactive Column Chart Showing Application Type

9. **Report Navigation:** Scroll down to the embedded *All Application Report* table located under the "Under Review Status" panel. Click the top-right options icon (three vertical dots).

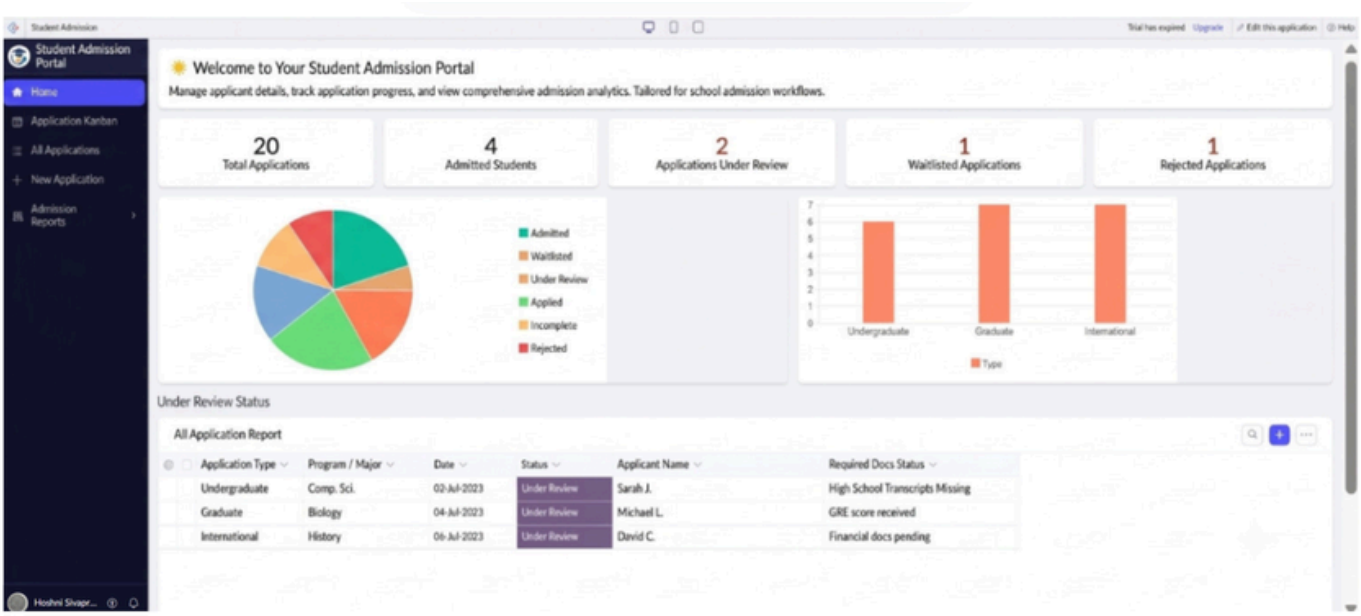
5. STEP-BY-STEP EXECUTION PROCEDURE (CONTD.)

10. **Report Display Format Exploration:** Open the **Show As** flyout menu. Record all six listed view formats: *List, Calendar, Timeline, Spreadsheet, Kanban,* and *Import*. Confirm that *List* carries a active tick mark.



Built-in Report Views in the All Application Report

11. **Launch Application Editor:** Click the top-right button labeled **Edit this application** to navigate into the Zoho Creator Development Environment (IDE).
12. **Inspect Design Workspace:** Navigate through the *Design* tab (Forms, Reports, Pages) to search for any Zia AI panels, natural language builders, or AI assistant prompts.



Zoho Creator Application Editor - Design Area

13. **Inspect Workflows & Account Status:** Check the *Workflows* section. Record that while standard business rules exist, Zia AI tools are absent, and note the banner displaying Trial has expired - Upgrade.

6. OBSERVATIONS AND ANALYTICAL FINDINGS

A. Dashboard KPI Summary

The top metric panel synthesizes real-time applicant counts across key administrative stages:

Key Performance Indicator (KPI)	Recorded Metric Value
Total Applications	**20**
Admitted Students	**4**
Applications Under Review	**2**
Waitlisted Applications	**1**
Rejected Applications	**1**

B. Under Review Record Details

Detailed view of applicant records filtered under the active review queue on the dashboard:

App Type	Program / Major	Submission Date	Status	Applicant Name	Required Docs Status
Undergraduate	Comp. Sci.	02-Jul-2023	Under Review	Sarah J.	High School Transcripts Missing
Graduate	Biology	04-Jul-2023	Under Review	Michael L.	GRE score received
International	History	06-Jul-2023	Under Review	David C.	Financial docs pending

C. Dynamic Chart Interaction Analysis

Chart Type	Cursor Target / Hover Result	Analytical Interpretation
Status Pie Chart	Hovered Admitted Segment → Status - Admitted: 4	Precisely 20% (4 of 20) of total applicants have completed admission.
Program Column Chart	Hovered Undergraduate Bar → Type - Undergraduate: 6	Undergraduate degree applications form the largest single program tier.

D. Built-in Report Display Options

Format Option	General Functional Description	Observation Status
List	Tabular row-and-column layout with field sorting.	Active default (Ticked)
Calendar	Maps entries onto monthly/weekly calendar grids.	Available in menu
Timeline	Arranges records sequentially along date ranges.	Available in menu
Spreadsheet	Provides an editable cell-based grid interface.	Available in menu
Kanban	Groups record cards into status-based swimlanes.	Available in menu
Impor t	Ingests structured external dataset files.	Available in menu

7. ZIA / AI-ASSISTED FEATURE EVALUATION

Account License Constraint: Inspection of the Design and Workflow areas in the application editor confirmed that Zia AI capabilities were unavailable due to an expired account trial (Trial has expired status). As a result, AI automated insights and conversational query features could not be evaluated live.

8. RESULT

The dashboard KPI metrics (Total: 20, Admitted: 4, Under Review: 2, Waitlisted: 1, Rejected: 1) were observed and verified.

Interactive hover tooltips on the pie chart and column chart were successfully evaluated.

All six built-in report views were identified within the *Show As* menu.

The absence of Zia AI features under the current expired account state was documented.

9. CONCLUSION

The experiment successfully demonstrated Zoho Creator's built-in analytics, dynamic chart hover features, and multi-format report display capabilities. While Zia AI assistant features require an active premium license, native dashboard widgets effectively support real-time institutional decision-making without external code.